Reading and writing

2026-11-20 | Week 6 | Observe and explain

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.7D

3.7D: Retell and paraphrase texts in ways that maintain meaning and logical order. In plain English: Retell or put a text into your own words while keeping its meaning and order. Today: Retell the pumpkin problem, action and result.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.7C

4.7C: Use text evidence to support an appropriate response. In plain English: Support an answer with something the text actually says or shows. Today: Explain how her actions and attitude change, using evidence.

I Do

Read a short, accessible scene from A Chair for My Mother. Grade 3: say, "We are learning to retell the pumpkin problem, action and result." and model one response with a picture, prop or dictated sentence. Grade 4: say, "We are learning to explain how her actions and attitude change, using evidence." and model a response that points to the same scene as evidence.

We Do

Reread the same scene aloud. Both learners handle the same book, illustrations and props. Grade 3 practices the target by arranging, pointing, speaking, using AAC or dictating a response. Grade 4 practices the separate target by explaining, comparing or citing evidence from that same scene. Fade the model, return to the page, then switch teacher rotations.

You Do

Use one fresh question about A Chair for My Mother. Grade 3: Retell the pumpkin problem, action and result. Grade 4: Explain how her actions and attitude change, using evidence. Record each response, the page or illustration used and the help given.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: The learner not with the teacher uses a previously taught response sort, scene sequence, prop match or known Vizzle task from A Chair for My Mother; the teacher then switches and teaches the other learner from the same scene.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. Use three fresh items for the Friday subject check. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Real books: A Chair for My Mother. Bring the props and response mats in the weekly book guide.

Writing TEKS 3.7B

Write a response to a literary or informational text that demonstrates an understanding of a text.

Writing TEKS 4.7B

Write responses that demonstrate understanding of texts, including comparing and contrasting ideas across a variety of sources.

Writing and spelling

After the shared read-aloud, each learner makes an individual response from the same book. Grade 3: Retell the pumpkin problem, action and result. Grade 4: Explain how her actions and attitude change, using evidence. Use the planned response mode and record composition separately from oral or picture evidence.

8-9 AM read-aloud

Too Many Pumpkins by Linda White. Return to the real pages for evidence; see the weekly book guide.

Math

2026-11-20 | Week 6 | Observe and explain

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.3C, 3.3D

3.3C: Explain that the unit fraction 1/b represents the quantity formed by one part of a whole that has been partitioned into b equal parts where b is a non-zero whole number. In plain English: Explain that a unit fraction is one equal part of a whole. 3.3D: Compose and decompose a fraction a/b with a numerator greater than zero and less than or equal to b as a sum of parts 1/b. In plain English: Build and break apart a fraction as a sum of unit fractions. Today: Make one whole from fourths; separate it into two smaller fractional amounts.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.3C, 4.3D

4.3C: Determine if two given fractions are equivalent using a variety of methods. In plain English: Determine whether two fractions name the same amount. 4.3D: Compare two fractions with different numerators and different denominators and represent the comparison using the symbols >, =, or <. In plain English: Compare fractions with different numerators and denominators using >, = or <. Today: Compare one half with three fourths using matching whole lengths.

I Do

Grade 3: Join three one-fourth pieces to make three fourths. Separate into two fourths and one fourth. Grade 4: Place one half and one fourth on equal-size wholes. Show the greater amount and compare two fourths with one half.

We Do

Both students handle the shared materials. Practice one example with the teacher; then teach the two targets in separate rotations. Grade 4: compare 1/2 and 3/4 on equal-length wholes and record 1/2 < 3/4. This pair has different numerators and denominators.

You Do

Grade 3: Make one whole from fourths; separate it into two smaller fractional amounts. Grade 4: Compare one half with three fourths using matching whole lengths.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Complete a mastered counting/sorting tray or known Bridges practice task at the student's established level.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. Use three fresh items for the Friday subject check. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Counters, plates/cups and the linked math mat. Select the matching grade-level STEMscopes lesson. Use Bridges placement to choose a separate foundational intervention.

Science

2026-11-20 | Week 6 | Observe and explain

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.8B

3.8B: Plan and conduct investigations that demonstrate how the speed of an object is related to its mechanical energy. In plain English: Plan and carry out a test connecting an object's speed to its mechanical energy. Today: Compare slow and faster runs of the same car; use the effect on a foam block to explain the relationship between speed and mechanical energy.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.7

4.7: Plan and conduct descriptive investigations to explore the patterns of forces such as gravity, friction, or magnetism in contact or at a distance on an object. In plain English: Plan and conduct investigations to find patterns in gravity, friction or magnetism. Today: Test a pattern in gravity, friction or magnetism.

I Do

Compare ramp height for grade 3; compare surface friction for grade 4. Change one factor at a time.

We Do

Complete three trials. Record prediction and observed result. Use the Friday science tasks to assess during the investigation. Grade 3: plan two releases of the same car, one slow and one faster, into the same lightweight foam block. Keep the car, block, surface and collision point fixed; reset the block and repeat three trials per condition. Record observed speed and how far the block moves. Use the greater observed effect as evidence about mechanical energy; do not use travel distance alone as a speed measurement.

You Do

Grade 3: Identify the observed faster run and point to evidence. Grade 4: Show friction, magnetic attraction or gravity using observed evidence.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Sort familiar object/photo matches away from the experiment station. Experiments are adult supervised.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. Use three fresh items for the Friday subject check. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Toy car, low ramp, stable blocks, felt, tray, tape, fraction strips, historical pictures. Adult manages circuit parts, magnets, small items and warm materials; use a low-voltage kit only.

Friday investigation

Leaf-and-ramp investigation: first observe and sort collected leaves by visible features as ungraded exploration. Test the same toy car on a bare ramp and a securely fixed dry-leaf surface. Grade 3 compares speed and the distance a foam block moves after contact (3.8B); Grade 4 describes the friction pattern (4.7). Keep car, release point and ramp height constant; repeat three trials. Do not infer energy from leaf color. Grade 3 uses the same car and foam block for slow/faster trials, resets the block each time and compares the effects. Grade 4 changes only the track surface for the friction comparison.

Social studies

2026-11-20 | Week 6 | Observe and explain

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.14B

3.14B: Differentiate and compare the information about a specific issue or event provided in primary and secondary sources. In plain English: Compare what firsthand sources and later accounts say about the same issue or event. Today: Compare two sources and support one claim.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.3B

4.3B: Summarize the significant contributions of individuals such as William B. Travis, James Bowie, David Crockett, Juan N. Seguín, Plácido Benavides, José Francisco Ruiz, Antonio López de Santa Anna, Susanna Dickinson, and Enrique Esparza. In plain English: Explain how important individuals contributed to the Texas Revolution. Today: Use a source to explain an event or contribution.

I Do

Grade 3: Compare two sources and support one claim. Model with one district source, naming the visible clue. Grade 4: Use a source to explain an event or contribution. Use the current Texas history map, image or excerpt; name the person/event and point to the evidence.

We Do

Work together with a second example from the same source set. One source + one timeline placement + one cause/effect response. Keep the grade-specific question visible and fade added hints.

You Do

Grade 3: Compare two sources and support one claim. Grade 4: Use a source to explain an event or contribution. Use a fresh source/card; accept a model, pointing, AAC or a spoken explanation.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Match two familiar source pictures or complete a known picture-to-object task.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. Use three fresh items for the Friday subject check. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

District source pictures or excerpts, two-event sequence mat and writing/history frames. The classroom texts do not replace Texas history sources.